Daniel Okafor

Senior Backend Engineer

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London (open to hybrid) · GitHub: github.com/dokafor
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PROFILE

Backend engineer with 14 years of experience building reliable payment and logistics platforms. I design pragmatic systems, lead teams through migrations without drama, and care about observability, testing and clear documentation. Most at home in TypeScript, Go and PostgreSQL on AWS.

WORK HISTORY

Staff Engineer

Jan 2022 – Present

Northwind Payments · London

- Designed and led delivery of a payments service handling 40 million requests a day with 99.95% availability
- Mentored eight engineers through code review, pairing and design reviews
- Introduced contract tests between services, cutting integration incidents by half
- Set up on-call and incident reviews with product and support teams
- Led the migration from a monolith to six services over 18 months with no unplanned downtime
- Wrote the engineering career framework adopted across 90 engineers

Senior Software Engineer

May 2018 – Dec 2021

Parcelly · London

- Owned the dispatch API handling 12 million requests a day
- Reduced p95 latency from 900 ms to 180 ms by redesigning caching and queries
- Ran the hiring loop for backend engineers and onboarded six new starters
- Worked with operations to prioritise reliability work over new features during peak season
- Built route optimisation APIs used by 3,000 drivers daily

SKILLS

Languages

TypeScript · Go · Python · SQL

Platforms

AWS · PostgreSQL · Kafka · Redis · Kubernetes · Terraform

Practices

System design · Observability · Testing strategy · Incident management · Mentoring

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional
Amazon Web Services · 2024

Software Engineer
Mar 2015 – Apr 2018

Ledgerline · Manchester

- Built the reconciliation service that matched 2 million ledger entries a day
- Replaced nightly batch jobs with event-driven processing, cutting delays from hours to minutes
- Wrote the team's first testing guidelines and raised coverage on core modules

Software Engineer
Jan 2013 – Feb 2015

Brightwave Digital · Manchester

- Built e-commerce sites for retail clients in PHP and JavaScript
- Improved page load times by caching product catalogues

Junior Developer
Jul 2011 – Dec 2012

Ashdown IT Services · Leeds

- Maintained internal tools and wrote reporting scripts

IT Support Technician
Jun 2010 – Jun 2011

Leeds City Council · Leeds

- Supported 400 staff with hardware, accounts and software issues

PROJECTS

Open-source rate limiter
2020

Maintainer · github.com/dokafor/tokenbucket

- Go library for distributed rate limiting used in production by several companies

Payments reliability playbook
2023

Author

- Internal guide to idempotency, retries and reconciliation for payment flows

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science
2007 – 2010

University of Leeds · Leeds